Food chains

A **food chain** shows how energy is transferred from organism to organism in the food they eat. For example, grain is eaten by a chicken. The chicken is then eaten by a fox. Energy transfers from the grain to the chicken to the fox.

☞ **1** Unjumble the following food chains. Put the first organism to be eaten at the bottom and the last organism at the top.

A cat, caterpillar, lettuce, bird

B grain, fox, owl, mouse

C grass, human, sheep

D snake, fly, frog

E lion, grass, zebra

F fish, shark, sea grass

A	B	C	D	E	F
↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by
↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by
↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by				

2 Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Word bank

fish sea eat bigger plankton livers poison metals stored food lots

Sometimes poisonous metals are washed into the s_____. The quantities are very small and the metals are absorbed by the p_____ in the sea. Small f_____ eat the plankton and are not harmed by the metals. The poison is s_____ in their livers. Bigger fish such as tuna e_____ lots of the small fish. Each time these b_____ fish eat the small fish they eat the stored p_____ too. The bigger fish have bigger l_____ and can tolerate more poison. A shark then eats l_____ of the bigger fish and takes in the poison too. This is how poisonous m_____ can accumulate in a f_____ chain.

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